DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE
Headquarters Air Force
Washington DC 20330-1030

Air Force Job Qualification Standard
8A300 SDI Protocol
15 July 2026

Air Force Job Qualification Standard (AFJQS)
Protocol
Special Duty Identifier (SDI) (8A300)

ACCESSIBILITY: Publications and forms are available on the e-publishing website at https://www.e-publishing.af.mil/ for downloading or ordering.

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1. PURPOSE. This AFJQS identifies tasks and duty requirements for individuals performing duties with the Protocol Special Duty Identifier (SDI). It provides the minimum training requirement and standardizes on-the-job training (OJT) tasks necessary to successfully manage the Air Force Protocol program. This AFJQS serves as a roadmap to develop the Master Training Plan (MTP). This AFJQS will remain in effect until superseded or rescinded.

2. TASK QUALIFICATION. Personnel will be qualified to the GO/NO GO standard on this AFJQS. GO means the individual can perform the task without assistance utilizing appropriate instructions or other procedural guidance. Go also means trainee meets local requirements for accuracy and timeliness.

3. ADDITIONAL DUTY or TASK. If personnel are assigned an additional duty or task not listed in this AFJQS, the supervisor will develop an AF IMT 797, *Job Qualification Standard Continuation/Command JQS.* The supervisor/trainer will then develop a plan for the member to receive training and become duty position qualified.

4. TRAINING DOCUMENTATION AND TRAINER/CERTIFIER IDENTIFICATION. Document training required by this AFJQS in accordance with DAFMAN 36-2689, *Training Program.* This AFJQS is approved for use in an automated training management systems.

5. This AFJQS has been coordinated with all applicable CFMs. Overall POC for this AFJQS is HAF/A1S, DSN 260-1266, usaf.pentagon.af-a1.mbx.af-a1s-workflow@mail.mil.

BY ORDER OF THE SECRETARY OF THE AIR FORCE

OFFICIAL

BOBBY D. DRAYTON, CMSgt, USAF
Protocol Career Field Manager

Attachment
Air Force Job Qualification Standard Task List

PART II. AFJQS PROTOCOL TASK LIST					
			CERTIFICATION		
Task Number	Tasks, Knowledge and Technical References	Start Date	Complete Date	Trainee Initials	Trainer Initials
1	**PROTOCOL PROGRAM OVERVIEW** **TR: DAFI 90-1201; AFPAM 34-1202; DAFECD-SDI 8A300 Protocol; and Local Guidelines**				
1.1	Complete Air University MFSS200 Air Force Protocol Fundamentals Course at Maxwell, AFB AL ◊ *Schedule through MAJCOM Protocol*				
1.2	Read and comprehend governing DAF Instructions: DAFI 90-1201 and AFPAM 34-1202				
1.3	Describe, understand, and recognize the impact of Protocol Officer Responsibilities				
1.4	Knowledge of local area and installation guidelines that affect Protocol Office operations				
2	**FLAGS AND PLATES** **TR: U.S. Code: Title 4; DAFI 90-1201; and AFPAM 34-1202**				
2.1	Demonstrate and understand proper US Flag etiquette and appropriate positions and manner of display in conjunction with precedence of other flags on display				
2.2	Knowledge of distinction and use of departmental, organizational, and positional flags				
2.3	Understand use of vehicle plates and distinctions				
2.4	Understand purchase/acquisition process for flags and associated equipment in proper sizes				
3	**FUNDING** **TR: DAFI 90-1201; AFMAN 34-1202; AFI 65-603; DoDI 7250.13; DoD 5500.7R (JER); DAFMAN 34-201**				
3.1	Understand the use of Operations & Maintenance (O&M) funds and the use of the Government Purchase Card (GPC)				
3.2	Understand the use of Special Morale & Welfare (SM&W) funds for events, personnel authorized to use funds, and how to distribute funds				
3.3	Understand the use of Official Representation Funds (ORF) program management, request/reconciliation process, authorized uses, and qualifying personnel/ratios				
3.4	Understand the use of Personal Funds, including handling responsibilities (collection and records management) and stewardship, when no Operations and Maintenance and Official Representation Funds are available				
3.5	Understand limits of DAF employees obligating US Government in contracts and agreements (e.g., hotel, catering)				
3.6	Coordinate reviews with financial management and legal teams for appropriate usage of appropriate funding sources				
4	**GIFTS AND MEMENTOS** **TR: DAFI 90-1201; AFI 65-603; AFI 34-201; AFI 51-506; 10 U.S.C. 2601(g); DoD 5500.7-R (JER), 5 U.S.C. § 2601 (*General gift funds)* and 2608 *(Acceptance of contributions for defense programs, projects, and*				

	***activities*); 5 U.S.C. § 7342 (*Receipt and disposition of foreign gifts and decorations*).**				
4.1	Understand ORF gift locker management, eligible recipients, and maximum spend limits				
4.2	Understand value limitations of receiving gifts from government employees, foreign governments, and outside sources				
4.3	Know how to research gift costs, obtain legal reviews, and disposition procedures				
4.4	Differentiate between funding sources (Operations and Maintenance, Official Representation Funds, or personal funds), business rules for inventory management, spending limits, and appropriate occasions				
4.5	Know proper etiquette and customs in presenting and receiving mementos and gifts				
5	**TRANSPORTATION** **TR: DAFI 90-1201; AFPAM 34-1202; DAFI 24-301; DAFI 24-302**				
5.1	Coordinate ground transportation: U-Drive-It (UDI) vehicles and surreys/buses				
5.2	Describe vehicle inspections and positioning				
5.3	Explain Military Airlift (Mil Air) categories, service codes, and DV codes				
5.4	Understand Base Operations policies and procedures for receiving and sending DV flights, understand limits of vehicle usage by Permanent Party and TDY Party personnel, domicile-to-duty transportation, and the use of rental vehicles				
5.5	Explain flight line logistics: access, safety, DV lounge, and red carpet				
5.6	Explain Transient Alert (TA)/aircraft parking				
5.7	Explain arrival and departure party requirements				
5.8	Coordinate luggage detail				
6	**TITLES, FORMS OF ADDRESS AND MILITARY ABBREVIATIONS** **TR: DAFI 90-1201**				
6.1	Understand Distinguished Visitor (DV) Codes				
6.2	Know military rank abbreviations for all military services				
6.3	Understand forms of address for foreign and domestic officials, executives, ambassadors, legislators, state government officials, academia, etc., and proper etiquette when addressing DVs				
6.4	Research rank equivalency and abbreviations for foreign DVs and align with U.S. counterparts				
6.5	Know how to properly address DAF Senior Leadership				
7	**PRECEDENCE** **TR: U.S. Order of Precedence; DoD Order of Precedence Memorandum; DAF Precedence List; DAFI 90-1201**				
7.1	Interpret U.S. precedence list with elected and appointed senior U.S. officials				
7.2	Comprehend DoD positional and organizational precedence and obtain rosters				
7.3	Understand foreign precedence and obtain rosters from U.S. Department of State				

7.4	Prioritize personnel from multiple levels and precedence lists into one precedence list for specific events				
7.5	Provide seating guidance based on precedence and able to defend situational adjustments				
8	**CUSTOMS AND COURTESIES TR: DAFI 90-1201 and AFI 1-1**				
8.1	Understand when salutes are appropriate for both indoor and outdoor occasions				
8.2	Know marks of respect, customs, and traditions of the Department of Air Force as well as be familiar with customs and traditions of other military services				
8.3	Can explain how to properly support senior leader office and courtesy calls				
8.4	Make proper introductions				
9	**ATTIRE TR:D AFI 90-1201; DAFI 36-2903**				
9.1	Advise and guide personnel regarding proper military uniforms appropriate for different events/occasions				
9.2	Advise and guide personnel regarding proper civilian attire, comparable to military equivalent appropriate for different events/occasions				
10	**ADMINISTRATION TR: DAFI 90-1201; AFI 33-322; AFPAM 34-1202; AFH 33-337**				
10.1	Prepare coordination requests for logistical support [e.g. Honor Guard, Band, lodging, transportation, flight line, baggage detail, escorts, security, communication, public affairs, and Entry Access Lists (EALs)]				
10.2	Prepare support products (e.g. welcome letter, table tents, name tags, menu cards, diagrams, seat charts, envelopes, memorandums, and labels)				
10.3	Prepare appropriate invitations, programs, scripts and event briefs				
10.4	Prepare professional, pointed, and effective email communications for dissemination to senior leaders				
10.5	Knowledge and file management of historical documents, continuity and After Action Reports (AAR) on shared drives, SharePoint, and Electronic Records Management drive				
10.6	Prepare accurate financial accountability forms, pro-rata sheets for events when personal money is collected and pay vendors on behalf of guests				
10.7	Assemble event coordination products and brief senior leaders on visits, events, and ceremony details and their roles				
11	**DISTINGUISHED VISITOR (DV) TR: DAFI 90-1201; AFPAM 34-1202**				
11.1	Explain DV notification requests, DV Codes, special access forms, and local installation guidance				
11.2	Develop detailed working plan for DV visit containing all information necessary to execute visit, including a contingency plan				
11.3	Able to develop and coordinate a detailed itinerary to meet the intent of both DV and Commander; include time consideration for transportation, movement, and				

	transitions; outline meal plans and lodging; list names of personnel involved (e.g. greeters, escorts, and briefers)				
11.4	Partner with support organizations to execute DV visits, events, and activities				
11.5	Coordinate personal security detail with Security Forces and/or Office of Special Investigation (OSI)				
11.6	Execute visit plans, make real-time adjustments, interact with DVs and local senior leaders to ensure visit success				
12	**CONFERENCES** **TR: DAFI 90-1201**				
12.1	Explain and differentiate Protocol role in guest management and logistics versus Project/Action Officer role developing content/briefing material/schedule				
12.2	Coordinate long-range planning details; site survey and venue contract, catering contract, transportation reservations, registration process, and lodging room blocks				
12.3	Ability to manage a comprehensive database or spreadsheet to include details such as names, RSVP data, meal selections, and other participant requirements/needs				
12.4	Coordinate short-range planning details; transportation and parking plans, seating charts and products, guest reception, and logistical agenda needs				
13	**OFFICIAL MILITARY CEREMONIES** **TR: DAFI 90-1201; DAFI 36-3203; DAFI 51-509; AFPAM 34-1202; DAFPAM 34-1203; DAFMAN 36-2806**				
13.1	Understand how presiding official or host makes key ceremony decisions and how rank or position can dictate the level of protocol, support, and honors				
13.2	Understand how to plan and execute official individual or personal ceremonies (e.g. Retirements, Promotions, Awards, Medals, Oath of Office, and Reenlistments)				
13.3	Understand how to plan and execute organizational ceremonies (e.g. Change of Command, Activation, Deactivation, Awards, Groundbreaking, Ribbon Cutting, and Graduations)				
13.4	Ability to create official invitations, hard copy and electronic, disseminate invitations, and collect responses and attendee requirements				
13.5	Communicate, coordinate, and organize people, resources, and information to effectively brief senior leaders and execute ceremonies appropriately				
14	**OFFICIAL SOCIAL FUNCTIONS** **TR: DoDI 1315.09; DAFI 90-1201; AFPAM 34-1202**				
14.1	Plan full details, both long and short range, for official engagements hosted by senior officials (e.g. dinners, luncheons, receptions, and socials)				
14.2	Provide limited advice and guidance for volunteers who plan unofficial events (e.g. holiday parties, non-DV meal events, etc.)				
14.3	Explain Enlisted Aides role and coordination, especially the conduct of Qualifying Representational Events Officers and Protocol personnel to assist				

14.4	Understand proper hospitality and dining etiquette				